

Which Organizer, When?

Unit 1 · Foundations of Constitutional Government (GC.01–GC.09)

Match the task to the tool —
then teach the *why*.

Students don't need more worksheets — they need the **right thinking tool** for the task in front of them. Find the *verb* in the assignment, then reach for the organizer built for that kind of thinking.

45-minute class? Plan **one** deep organizer (~20 min) or **two** quick ones (~10 min each), plus warm-up & discussion. Every page prints its own time estimate.

WHEN THE TASK ASKS STUDENTS TO...	REACH FOR	≈ TIME	BECAUSE IT WORKS
Compare two things	● Venn diagram · T-chart	10–15 MIN	The overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. <i>Marzano's #1 strategy.</i>
Compare three or more on set criteria	● Comparison matrix	15–20 MIN	Holds many cases against the same yardstick so patterns pop.
Trace causes & effects	● Cause & Effect	15–20 MIN	Makes the chain of “why it happened” visible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Put steps in order / show a process	● Timeline · Sequence	15–20 MIN	Sequence exposes how one step makes the next possible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Brainstorm & connect ideas	● Concept web	10–15 MIN	Surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to one hub.
Summarize — find the main point	● Main Idea & Details	10–15 MIN	Separates the big idea from the details that support it.
Activate prior knowledge & track learning	● K-W-L chart	10–15 MIN	Sets a purpose and makes thinking metacognitive. <i>UDL self-regulation.</i>
Learn a key term	● Frayer model	10–15 MIN	Builds deep word knowledge — not a definition students forget by Friday.
Analyze a source	● HIPPO	15–20 MIN	Gives students a historian's routine for interrogating a document.
Make an evidence-based claim	● C-E-R	20–25 MIN	Turns an opinion into a defensible argument: claim, evidence, reasoning.
Weigh two sides or options	● T-chart · Problem–Solution	15–20 MIN	Forces a decision that rests on evidence from both sides.
Get the basics of an event	● 5 Ws	5–10 MIN	Fast, complete factual capture — who, what, when, where, why.
Connect the nation to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	10–15 MIN	Local ties make national civics stick — and it's what sets Government Hack apart. Our signature move.

Social Studies Practices Crosswalk

Every organizer doubles as a *skills tool*.

Unit 1 · Foundations of Constitutional Government (SSP.01–SSP.06)

The Tennessee **Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–06)** are the skills every unit must build. This crosswalk maps each practice to the organizers that develop it — and shows **where** it lives in Unit 1 — so a graphic organizer is never busywork: it is deliberate practice toward a standard.

PRACTICE	WHAT STUDENTS DO (TN SSP)	ORGANIZERS THAT BUILD IT	WHERE IN UNIT 1
● SSP.01	Collect data & information from a variety of primary and secondary sources.	5 Ws · Main Idea & Details · K-W-L	GC.05 Preamble (Main Idea & Details); K-W-L to open the unit.
● SSP.02	Critically examine a source: purpose, point of view, evidence vs. assertion, bias.	HIPPO · C-E-R	GC.02 founding documents (HIPPO); blank HIPPO on any primary source.
● SSP.03	Synthesize data from several sources; compare accounts; frame new questions.	Comparison Matrix · Concept Web · Venn	GC.01 roots (Concept Web); GC.06 & GC.09 (Venn); GC.08 Bill of Rights (Matrix).
● SSP.04	Construct & communicate arguments citing supporting evidence.	C-E-R · T-Chart · Problem–Solution	GC.03 Articles & GC.04 Federalists vs. Anti-Federalists (T-Chart); C-E-R blank.
● SSP.05	Develop historical awareness: cause, context, continuity & change over time.	Timeline · Cause & Effect · Sequence	GC.02 English rights → Declaration (Cause & Effect); GC.07 amendment process (Sequence).
● SSP.06	Develop geographic awareness: patterns and scale from local to national.	Tennessee Connection · Matrix	Limited in Foundations; primary geographic focus lands in Unit 7 (TN State & Local). Use the ★ Tennessee Connection to bridge.

Venn Diagram — Compare Two

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Two

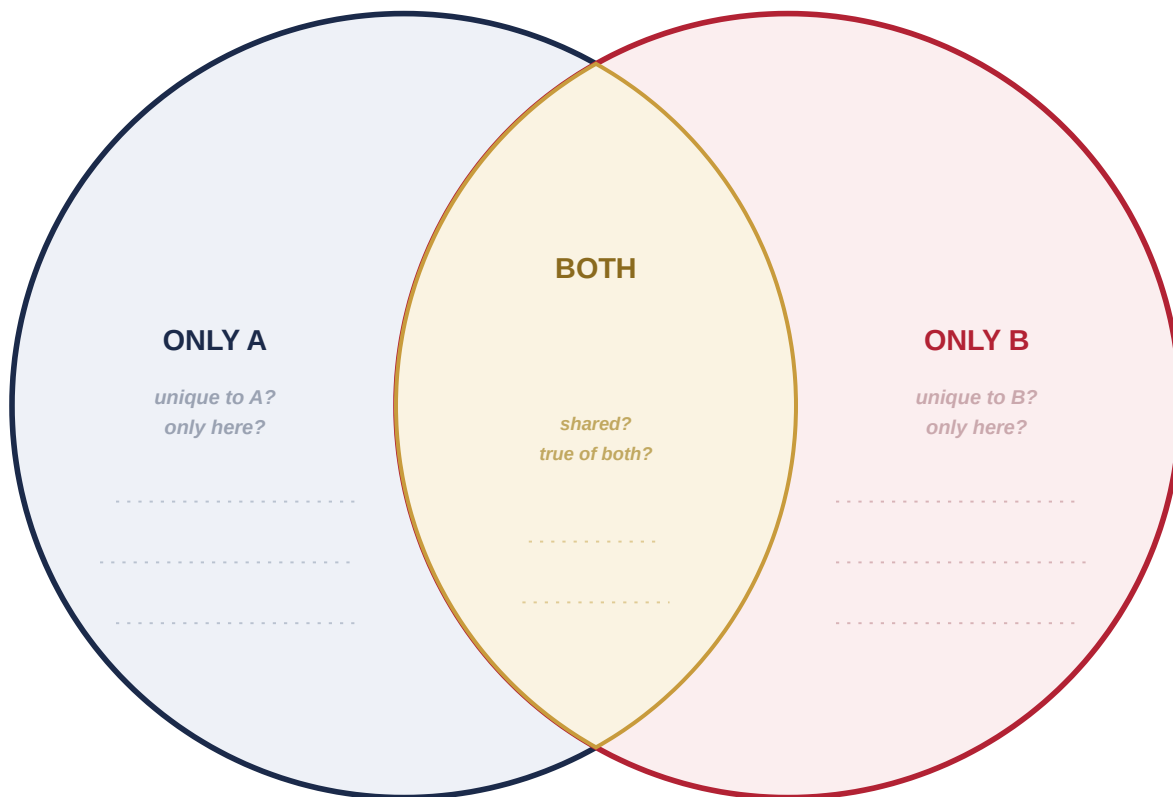
Marzano #1

WHEN · WHY Reach for a Venn when students compare **two** things: the overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. *Identifying similarities & differences is Marzano's highest-yield strategy.*

Write what makes each unique in its own circle — and what they share in the middle.

Topic A: _____
write in the left circle

Topic B: _____
write in the right circle



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank of traits to sort into the three regions before writing.

EXTEND

Use the overlap to write one sentence explaining what the two share at a deeper level.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Venn Diagram — Compare Three

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Three

Synthesis

WHEN · WHY Use a three-circle Venn to compare **three** things at once and find what any two — or all three — share.
Synthesizing across sources builds TN Practice SSP.03.

Place each example in the right region. What belongs to one, to a pair, or to all three?

● **Topic 1**

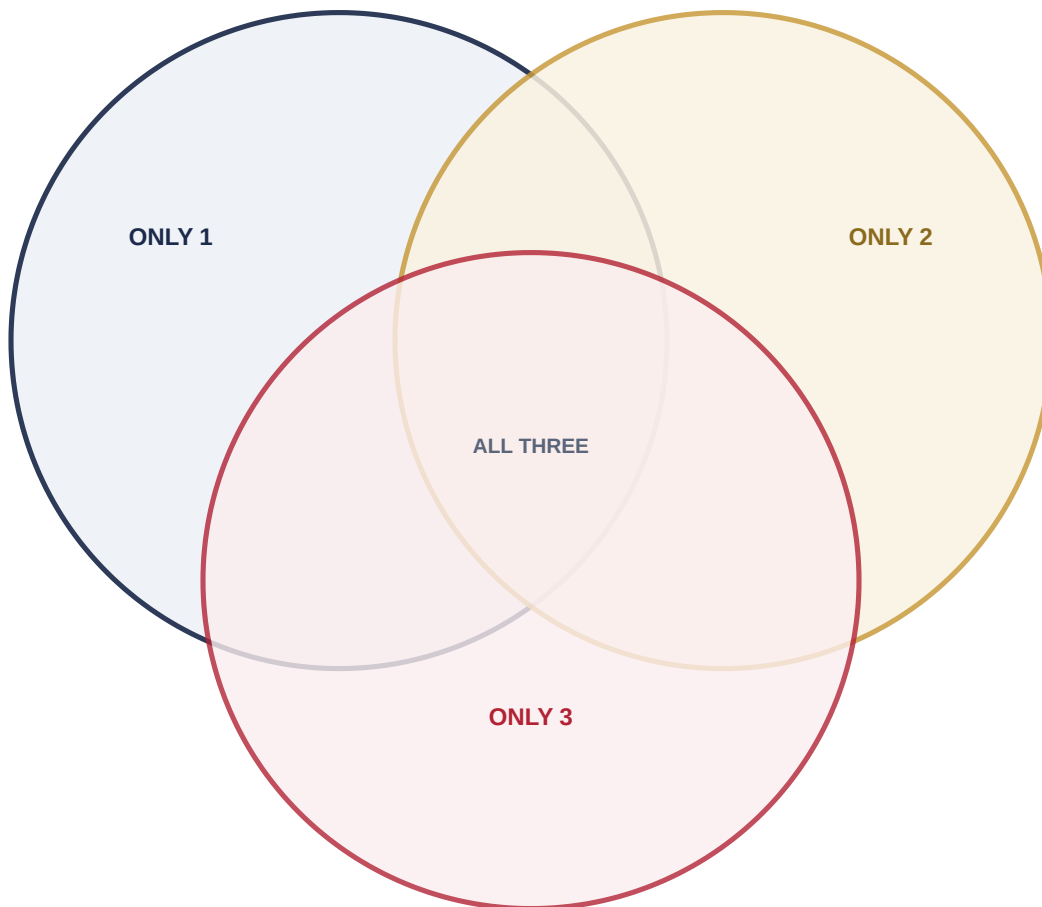
write examples in the circle

● **Topic 2**

write examples in the circle

● **Topic 3**

write examples in the circle



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SCAFFOLD

Start by placing three sure examples — one clearly in each 'only' region — then work toward the overlaps.

EXTEND

Explain why the center region (all three) is the hardest to fill — what must be true there?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

T-Chart · Two Sides

DOK 2–3

Gather evidence on each side — then use the bottom line to decide.

SIDE B
label this column

Point 2 add your evidence

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There is no text or other markings on the paper.This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are approximately 20 lines visible. The paper has a thin red border on the left and right sides, suggesting it might be part of a notebook or binder. The top edge of the paper is slightly irregular, possibly indicating where it was torn from a stack.

Weigh it: Based on both columns, what do you conclude? _____

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Fill one strong point on each side together, then students add two more per side.

Write a one-paragraph judgment that uses evidence from **both** columns.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY When students compare **three or more** cases against the same criteria, a matrix holds them to one yardstick so patterns pop. *Structured comparison is Marzano's highest-yield move.*

Fill each cell, then read down each column and across each row for patterns.

	Case 1 name it	Case 2 name it	Case 3 name it
Criterion A			
Criterion B			
Criterion C			
PATTERN	What pattern do you see across the cases? _____		

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Fill one full row together so students see how to compare across the same criterion.

EXTEND
Add a fourth case or a fourth criterion and predict where it would fall.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY Trace the chain of **why** something happened and what followed. *Cause-and-effect reasoning builds TN Practice SSP.05.*

CAUSES

EFFECTS

THE EVENT

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Provide two causes and two effects on cards; students place and then add one of each.

Draw an arrow from one effect to a new cause: how did one result trigger the next?

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Timeline — Change Over Time

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Timeline

SSP.05 Chronology

WHEN · WHY Put events in **order** to expose how one step made the next possible. *Chronological reasoning is TN Practice SSP.05.*

Write each date on the left, then explain why the event mattered.

Event 1 — what happened?

write the date

Event 2 — what happened?

Event 3 — what happened?

Event 4 — why did it matter?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the events on cards; students order them on the spine first, then add significance.

EXTEND

Add arrows between nodes to show cause & effect across the sequence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Concept Web

⌚ 10-15 min

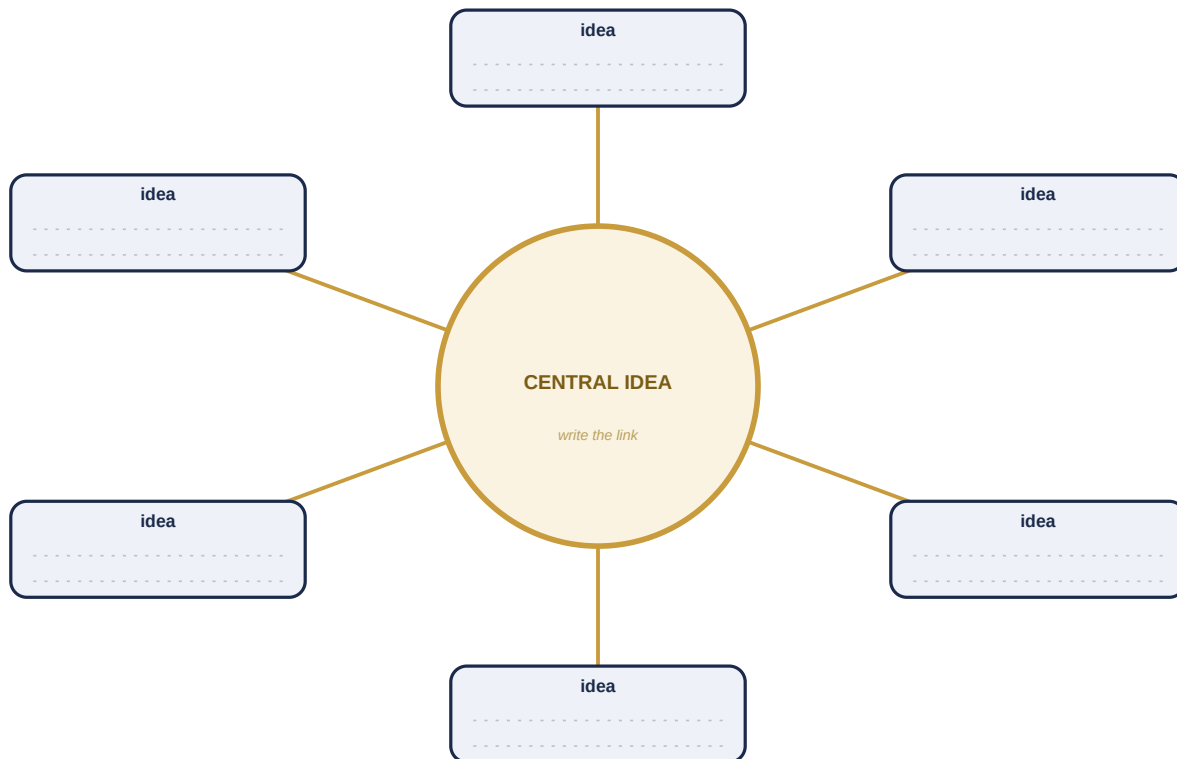
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Concept Web

Schema

WHEN · WHY **Brainstorm** and connect ideas around one central concept — it surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to a hub. *Building schema is a UDL comprehension support.*

Write the central idea in the hub, then fill each bubble with a connected idea — and name the link.



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill two bubbles together and model naming the link on the connecting line.

EXTEND

Draw a line between two outer bubbles that connect to each other, not just to the hub.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Main Idea & Details

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Main Idea & Details

Summarize

WHEN · WHY Summarize by separating the big idea from the details that support it. *Distinguishing central idea from detail is core disciplinary literacy (SSP.02).*

Write the main idea on top; add supporting details below; then sum it up in one line.

MAIN IDEA

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

In one sentence: the main idea matters because _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Give the main idea and have students hunt only for the supporting details.

EXTEND
Rank the details from strongest to weakest support and justify the top one.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Fill K and W before you start; return to L after the lesson.

[illegible]

UDL · MTSS

Offer sentence starters: 'I already know...', 'I want to know...', 'I learned...'.

In the L column, note one thing you still wonder — a question for further inquiry.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

5 Ws

⌚ 5-10 min

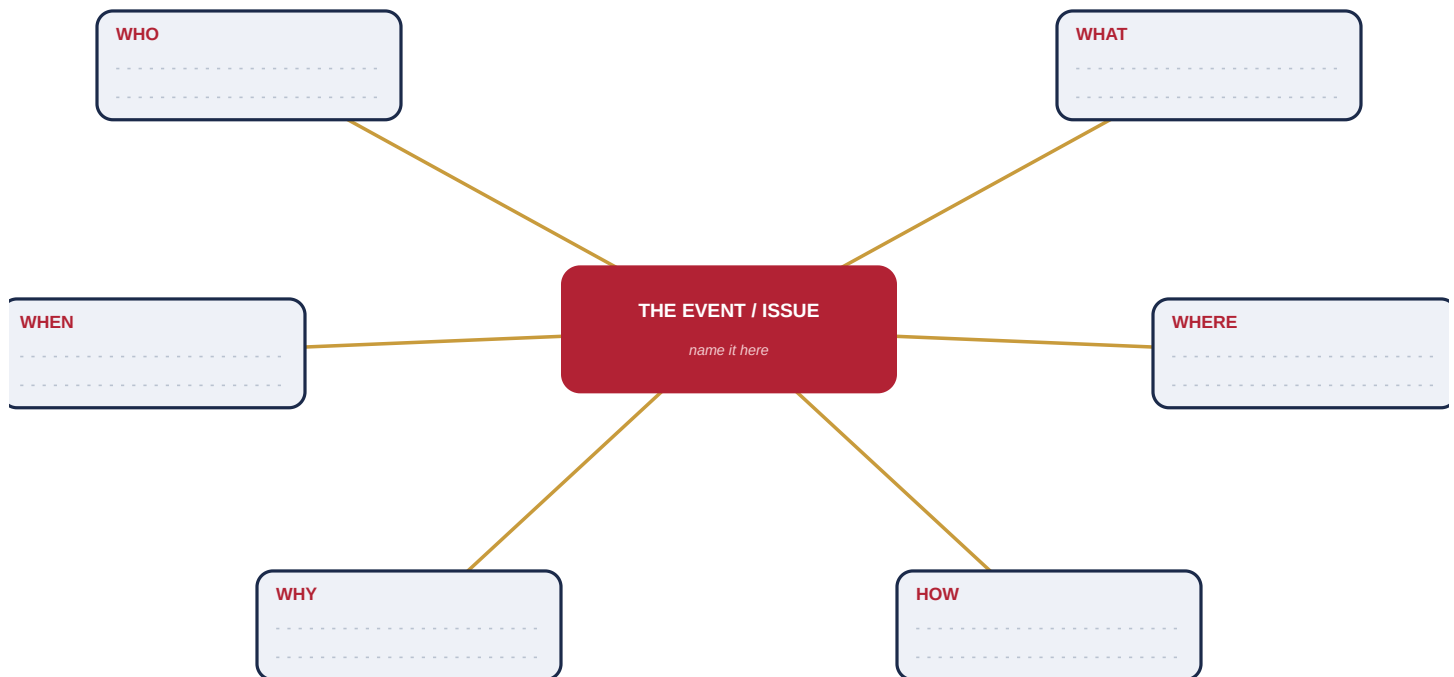
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

5 Ws

SSP.01

WHEN · WHY Capture the **basics of an event** fast — who, what, when, where, why (and how). *Collecting information from sources is TN Practice SSP.01.*

Name the event or issue in the center, then answer each question around it.



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Assign each question to a partner pair, then combine into one shared chart.

EXTEND

Turn the 'Why' and 'How' answers into a single cause-and-effect sentence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Problem & Solution

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Problem-Solution

Decision

WHEN · WHY Weigh options against a defined problem and decide with evidence, naming each trade-off. *Devising and defending solutions builds SSP.04.*

State the problem, sketch two possible solutions with their trade-offs, then decide.

THE PROBLEM

WHAT IS THE PROBLEM, EXACTLY?

Option A: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Option B: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Best solution: _____ — because _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide one worked solution with its trade-off; students generate the second.

EXTEND

Add a third option and rank all three by which trade-off is easiest to accept.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY Learn a key term deeply: definition, characteristics, examples, and non-examples — not a definition forgotten by Friday. *Robust vocabulary work is Marzano's six-step method.*

Write the term in the center, then complete all four corners.

DEFINITION (in your words)	CHARACTERISTICS (must-have traits)
TERM write the term	
EXAMPLES	EXAMPLES

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Give the definition; students generate the examples and non-examples.

EXTEND
Write one sentence that uses the term correctly in a new context.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Claim – Evidence – Reasoning

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

C-E-R

SSP.04 Argument

WHEN · WHY Turn an opinion into a **defensible argument**: a claim, the evidence for it, and the reasoning that ties them.
Constructing evidence-based arguments is TN Practice SSP.04.

Answer the question with a claim, back it with evidence, then explain your reasoning.

CLAIM — answer the question in one sentence

ONE CLEAR SENTENCE

EVIDENCE — specific facts / quotations that support the claim

QUOTE / FACT 1 ... QUOTE / FACT 2

REASONING — why the evidence proves the claim

HOW DOES THE EVIDENCE PROVE THE CLAIM?
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SCAFFOLD

Provide a claim stem and one piece of evidence; students supply the reasoning.

EXTEND

Add a counter-claim and one sentence explaining why your evidence still wins.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

HIPPO — Source Analysis

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

HIPPO

SSP.02

WHEN · WHY Give students a historian's routine for **interrogating a source**: context, audience, point of view, purpose, outside information. *Critically examining sources is TN Practice SSP.02.*

Record the source, then work through each element to analyze it.

Source: _____ title · author / creator · date · type

H

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

What was happening when this was made?

I

INTENDED AUDIENCE

Who was meant to see or read it?

P

POINT OF VIEW

Who made it — and how does that shape it?

P

PURPOSE

Why was it made? What did it want to do?

O

OUTSIDE INFORMATION

What do you know that connects to it?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Model H and I together on a shared source before students do P, P, O.

EXTEND

Use the O row to connect this source to another document you have studied.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Tennessee Connection

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

★ TN Connection

Signature Move

WHEN · WHY Connect the **nation** to **Tennessee** — local ties make national civics stick. This is our signature move.
Relevance and connection to students' lives is a UDL engagement principle.

Note the national idea on the left and its Tennessee counterpart on the right, then link them.

NATIONAL		TENNESSEE
	how are they connected? ★ CONNECTS TO	

How are they linked? _____

Why the local story matters: _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give the national example; students find the Tennessee counterpart with a provided source.

EXTEND

Explain how the Tennessee case is similar to *and* different from the national one.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Roots of American Government

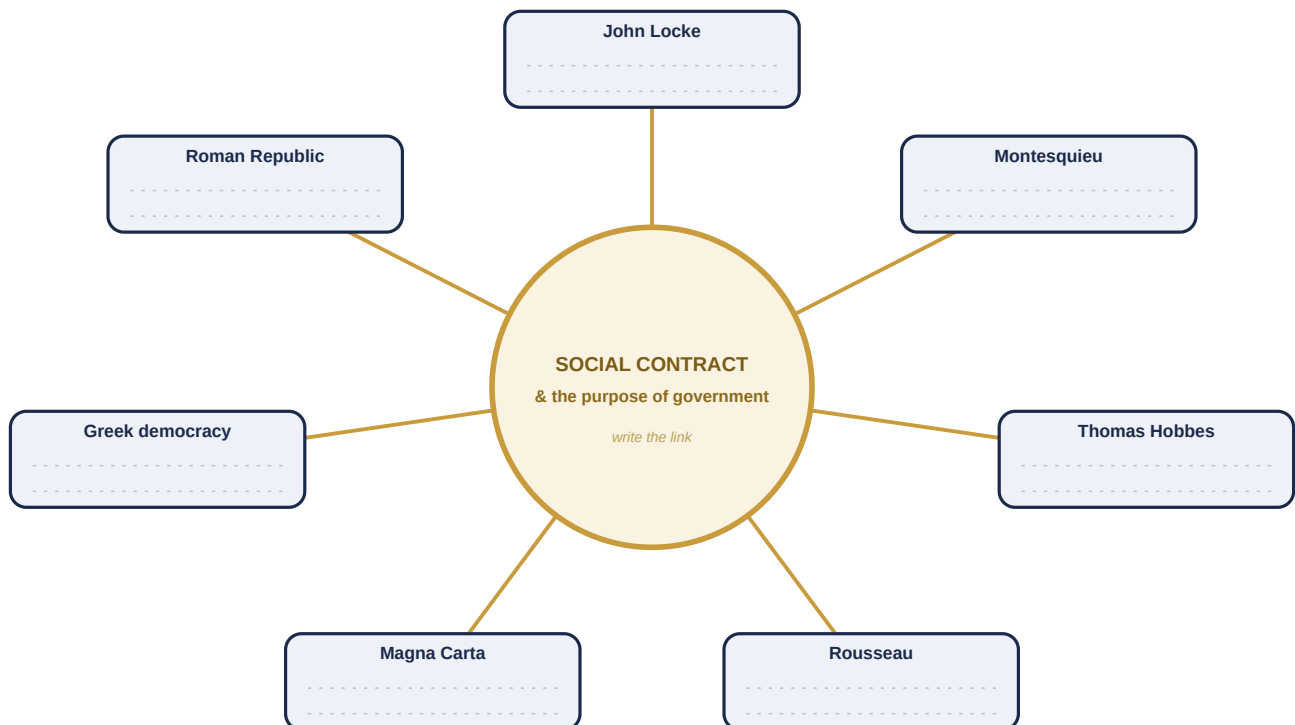
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Concept Web • Connect Ideas

DOK 2–3 • Synthesis

WHEN • WHY The Framers borrowed from Enlightenment thinkers and classical models. A concept web lets students gather those influences around one hub — the **social contract** and the purpose of government. *Synthesizing multiple sources builds TN Practice SSP.03.*

In each bubble, note the idea this influence gave American government; in the hub, state the social contract.



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SCAFFOLD

Give a matching set (thinker → idea) to place first: e.g., Montesquieu → separation of powers.

EXTEND

In the hub, explain Social Contract Theory and connect it to the overall purpose of the U.S. government.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

From English Rights to the Declaration

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Cause & Effect • Chain

SSP.05 • DOK 2–3

WHEN • WHY English rights documents set expectations the colonists believed Britain violated — a chain that ends in the Declaration of Independence. Tracing it makes the “why” of 1776 visible. *Cause-and-effect reasoning is TN Practice SSP.05.*

Work down the chain: what each step established, and how it led to the next.

English rights traditions — *what did the Magna Carta, Petition of Right & English Bill of Rights guarantee?*

1

British actions in the colonies — *which of those established rights did colonists claim were violated?*

2

Colonial grievances — *how did colonists list and justify their complaints?*

3

Declaration of Independence (1776) — *how does it use those grievances to justify separation?*

4

Cite it: Name one grievance in the Declaration and the English document whose right it echoes.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide the three English documents as cards; students match each to the right it protects before building the chain.

EXTEND

Choose the grievance you find most serious and defend the choice with evidence from an English document.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

The Articles of Confederation

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

T-Chart · Two Sides

DOK 2–3

WHEN · WHY The nation’s first plan of government had real strengths and real weaknesses. A T-chart forces students to hold both before judging whether it needed replacing. *Weighing evidence on both sides builds argument (SSP.04).*

Define confederation, then gather evidence of what worked and what did not.

STRENGTHS
what the Articles could do

Structure what government did the Articles set up?

Powers held what was the national government allowed to do?

WEAKNESSES
what the Articles could not do

Missing powers could Congress tax or regulate trade?

Enforcement why was it hard to act as one nation?

Weigh it: Did the weaknesses require a new Constitution, or could the Articles have been fixed? _____

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SCAFFOLD Give a short word bank (tax, trade, army, amend, states) to sort into strengths vs. weaknesses.	EXTEND Write a one-paragraph judgment: keep, amend, or replace the Articles — and why.	SHOW IT YOUR WAY Students may write, say (record), draw , or build their response.

Federalists vs. Anti-Federalists

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

T-Chart · Two Positions

DOK 3 · Perspective

WHEN · WHY After the Great Compromise, ratification split the country. Laying the two positions side by side shows students that the Constitution was argued into existence, not simply announced. *Comparing viewpoints with evidence is TN Practice SSP.04.*

Give each side equal weight: their view of government power, key figures, and economic interests.

FEDERALISTS
favored ratifying the Constitution

Government power how strong should the national government be?

Key figures who argued for this side?

Economic interests whose interests lined up here?

ANTI-FEDERALISTS
opposed ratification as written

Government power why fear a strong central government?

Key figures who argued for this side?

Bill of Rights why demand one before ratifying?

Ratification: Which argument would have persuaded you in 1788 — and why? _____

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SCAFFOLD Sort a set of quotations/claims into the correct column before writing.	EXTEND Honors: cite evidence from the Federalist and Anti-Federalist papers on the fight over ratification.	SHOW IT YOUR WAY Students may write, say (record), draw, or build their response.
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"We the People ... in Order to..." — the purposes of government

Welfare & Liberty

“GENERAL WELFARE” • “BLESSINGS OF LIBERTY”

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Federalism — Who Holds Which Powers

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn • Federal / State

DOK 2–3

WHEN • WHY Federalism divides power between the national and state governments, with some powers shared. The 'I can' target asks students to **plot these powers on a Venn** — delegated, reserved, and concurrent. *Sorting by shared vs. unique traits is Marzano's highest-yield strategy.*

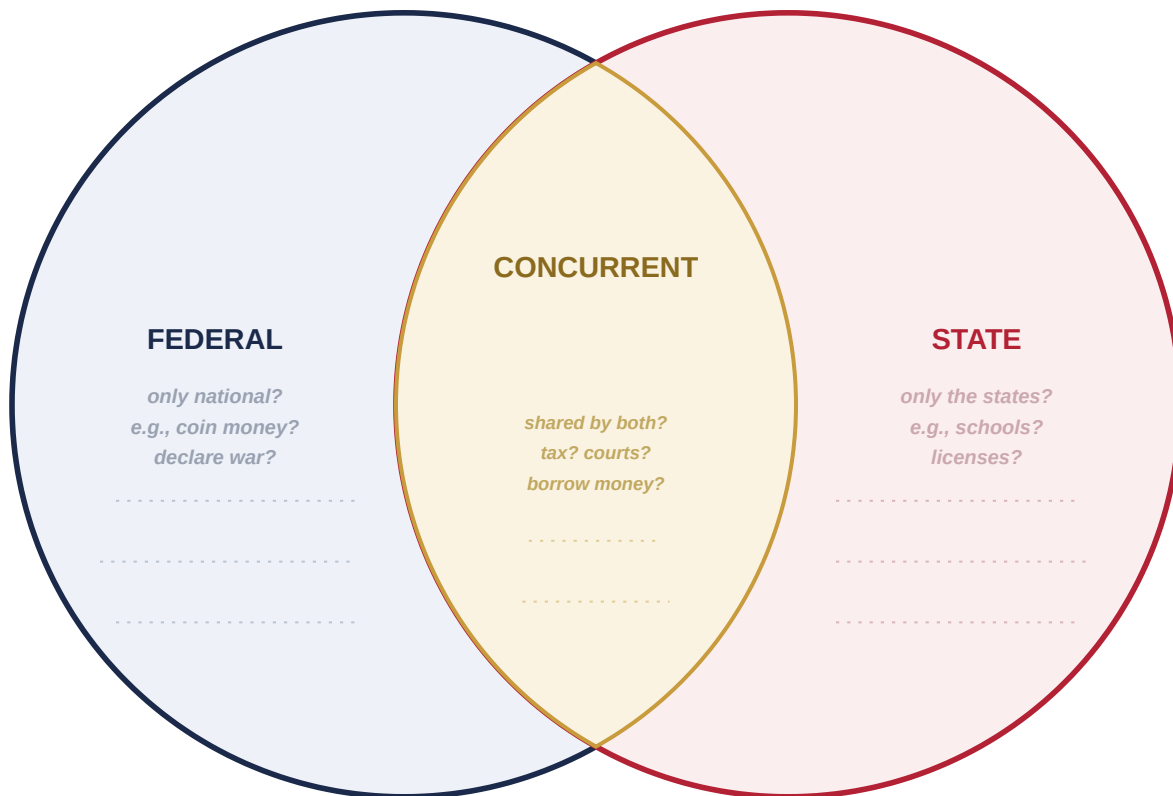
Place each power where it belongs: only national, only state, or shared by both.

FEDERAL — Delegated (Enumerated)

powers the national government holds

STATE — Reserved

powers kept by the states



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a card set of powers to sort into the three regions before writing them in.

EXTEND

Explain how the Supremacy Clause resolves a conflict between a federal and a state power.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Amending the Constitution (Article V)

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Sequence · Process Flow

SSP.05 · DOK 2

WHEN · WHY Article V sets a deliberately hard, two-stage path to change the Constitution: propose, then ratify — each with two methods. Mapping the flow shows students why amendments are rare. *Sequencing a process builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05).*

Work down the process. In each box, record both methods and the fraction each requires.

PROPOSE an amendment — *2/3 of both houses of Congress, or a national convention called by 2/3 of the states?*

1

RATIFY the amendment — *3/4 of state legislatures, or 3/4 of state ratifying conventions?*

2

Amendment added to the Constitution — *how many amendments have succeeded, out of thousands proposed?*

3

Why so hard? Name the two reasons the Framers built it this way (emphasis on federalism · checks & balances). _____

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SCAFFOLD

Provide the four methods on cards; students place each under Propose or Ratify first.

EXTEND

Summarize the seven articles of the Constitution and say which article each branch is defined in.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

The Bill of Rights — Limits on Government

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY The first eight Amendments each draw a boundary the government may not cross. A matrix holds all eight to the same two questions so the pattern — **limited government** — becomes unmistakable. *Tennessee law (T.C.A. § 49-6-1028) requires this instruction.*

For each Amendment, name the personal protection it guarantees and the limit it places on government.

	What it protects the personal right	How it limits government the boundary it draws
1st		
2nd		
3rd		
4th		
5th		
6th		
7th		
8th		
PATTERN		9th & 10th Amendments: How do they connect to federalism and rights not listed? _____

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SCAFFOLD

Pre-fill the 1st and 4th rows together, then students complete the rest.

EXTEND

Use an example to show how a national–state conflict over a right is resolved by the Supremacy Clause.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Democracy & Republic

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

WHEN • WHY “Democracy” and “republic” overlap more than students expect. A Venn examines the **relationship** between the two — and where a constitution limits each. *Comparing to find shared vs. distinct traits is Marzano's highest-yield move.*

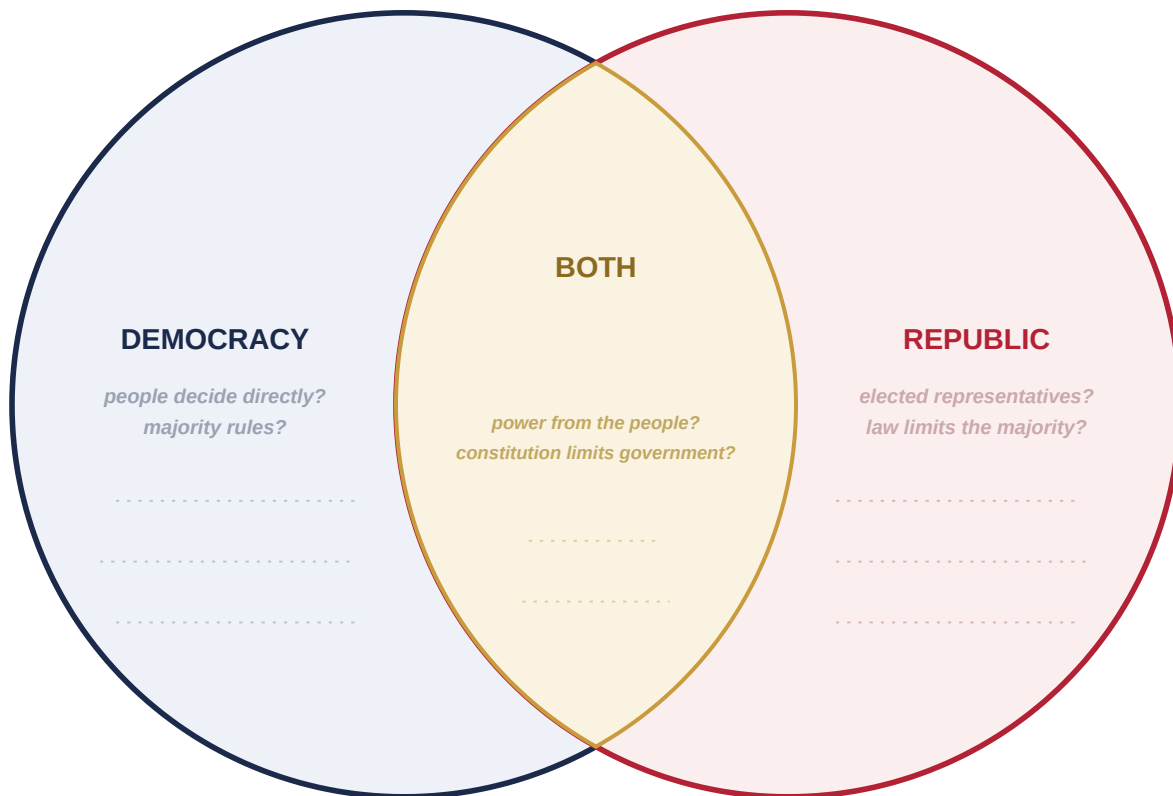
Sort each trait: **only a democracy**, **only a republic**, or **true of both** under a constitution.

DEMOCRACY

constitutional democracy

REPUBLIC

constitutional republic



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL • MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give one clear example of each (a direct vote vs. an elected legislature) to anchor the 'only' regions.

EXTEND

Give a real example of each and explain how the U.S. is best described as a constitutional republic.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.